M365-19 · Power Platform Governance (Power Automate / Power Apps)

A flow built by one person, running on their personal connection, moving organization data, that stops silently when they change role. The register, the guardrails, and the point at which a departmental solution has become an application.

Field	Value
Document ID	M365-19
Version	1.0 · Known Good edition, by Kevin Zelman
Catalogue domain	A. Microsoft 365
Operating tier	Tier 3 — Expert Services owns the environments, the DLP policies and the register. Tier 4 approves the connector classification and every exception to it. Tier 2 supports departmental builders on connections and permissions, which is where most faults actually are.
Primary audience	IT administrators. Departmental builders are the population this document governs rather than its audience — §3, §7 and Appendix B are written for them and should be published separately.
Review cycle	Annually, and on any change to the connector classification in §6.
Relationship to ACC-16 and GOV-04	A departmental solution that has grown past §9's triggers is an application. It goes through ACC-16 onboarding, and once adopted its changes are changes under GOV-04. This document owns the point at which that transition is recognised.

1. Purpose — the flow that stops when somebody leaves

Power Automate and Power Apps are, on balance, good for a small or mid-sized organization. A department that can build its own approval flow does not have to wait in a queue behind a stretched IT department for a developer who does not exist. Where IT is understaffed and most staff wear several hats, a records office that can automate its own reminder is solving a problem nobody else was going to get to. This document is written to keep that possible, not to stop it.

And then the person who built it changes role.

The failure is specific. A flow built by one person, running under their personal connection, moving organization data between systems, stops on the day their account is disabled. No alert reaches anybody who still works here. No ticket is raised, because nothing has been reported. The first symptom is somebody downstream noticing, several weeks later, that a spreadsheet has not updated since March, or that the notifications they had been relying on stopped arriving and they had assumed things were quiet. By then nobody can say what the flow did, because the person who knew has gone.

> **The same pathology as records in a personal OneDrive, on a worse surface**
>
> A common case: a departing senior staff member's organization records turn out to be held in a personal OneDrive, started years earlier. The organization recovers them by standing up a transition SharePoint site and re-permissioning the content under time pressure.
>
> That is organization function running on a personal asset — and it is the better of the two outcomes, because the files were still there to find.
>
> A flow is worse in three ways. The asset is a process rather than a document, so there is nothing to recover, only something that has stopped. The failure is silent, so the clock starts long before anybody notices. And nobody knows what stopped, because the flow was never written down anywhere but in itself.

Most organizations have no register of flows and apps today. This document assumes that rather than pretending otherwise, and §4 — building the first register — is therefore the first numbered thing it asks for, with an owner and a date.

2. The core failure mode, stage by stage

Stage	What is happening	Who knows
Build	A member of staff builds a flow to solve a real problem, in an afternoon, because waiting was not going to work. It does what it should.	They do.
Adoption	Colleagues start relying on it. It becomes part of how the department works. It is never documented, because it was never a project and nobody thought of it as a system.	Their team, informally.
Drift	It gets extended. It now touches a second system, then a third. Nobody reviews it, because there is nothing on any list to review.	Increasingly, nobody.
Departure	Their account is disabled under ACC-01 §7.2 — correctly, promptly, exactly as the procedure requires. The connection the flow runs on was theirs. The flow stops.	Nobody. There is no alert addressed to a person who still exists.
Discovery	Somebody notices a downstream effect weeks later and raises a ticket about the symptom, not the cause.	Whoever is affected.
Recovery	There is no owner, no documentation, and no way to know what it did without reading it — assuming anyone can still open it, which depends on where it was built (§5).	IT, under time pressure, with no context.

Every stage of that is normal behaviour by reasonable people. Which is why the remedy is a register and an ownership rule, rather than an instruction to be careful.

3. What departments may build without asking

Most of what people build needs no permission at all, and saying so first is important. The three categories below are meant to be quick to self-assess.

Category	Examples	What is required
GREEN — personal productivity	A flow that files your own mail, reminds you about your own tasks, saves your own meeting notes to your own OneDrive, or copies your own attachments somewhere sensible. Nothing organizational, nobody else's data, nothing anybody else depends on.	Nothing. Build it, in the default environment, and enjoy it. Not registered and not reviewed.
AMBER — departmental, registered	An approval flow behind a departmental Form. A notification when a document lands in the team site. A Power App the department uses to track its own equipment or room requests. Organization data, but inside one department and inside Microsoft 365.	Registered under §4. Runs on a group-owned connection or a service account (§7). Reviewed annually (§10). Built in a departmental environment (§5).
RED — not a citizen solution	Anything in §8 — anything touching the core business system of record, writing to a system of record, handling payroll or client records, changing accounts or permissions, or sending to a population.	Comes to IT as an application request (ACC-16) or a change (GOV-04). Not built first and disclosed afterwards.

- If you are not sure whether you are amber or red, register it and ask. Registering something that turns out to be green costs five minutes. Not registering something that turns out to be red costs somebody a Tuesday afternoon in about eighteen months, usually while they are covering for the person who built it.
- "Registered" is not "approved by IT", for amber. It means IT knows the thing exists, knows who owns it, and can tell the department when a migration is going to break it. That last point is the part departments actually benefit from, and it should be how the register is sold to them.
- Green solutions do occasionally become amber without anybody deciding to — the moment a colleague starts relying on it, it has changed category. §9 names the triggers.

4. The register — and building the first one

This section is first among the operational sections because nothing else in the document can be done without it. A DLP policy protects flows you know about. An attestation asks owners you can name. Neither exists yet.

1. Tier 3 produces an inventory of every flow and app in the tenant from the Power Platform admin centre: name, owner, environment, connectors used, last run, and run failure count. This is an export and a morning's work, not a project. OWNER: Tier 3. DUE: within 30 days of approval.
2. Triage first anything whose owner has already left, or whose connections are failing. Each one is dispositioned as still needed / stop it / rebuild it properly under §7. Expect this list to be longer than anybody predicts, and expect at least one item on it to matter.
3. Everything remaining gets an owner confirmed in writing by the department, plus one line saying what it does and one saying what breaks if it stops. Two sentences per solution is the entire documentation requirement, and it is enough.
4. Publish the register back to the departments, by department. This is what makes it useful to them rather than an audit imposed on them, and a department reading its own list will reliably find one it had forgotten about. That is the register earning its keep on day one.

5. From then on, registration happens at build time via Appendix A, and Tier 3 reconciles the register against a fresh admin-centre export quarterly (§10). A register maintained only by self-declaration decays quietly; one reconciled against the platform does not.
6. Cross-check the register against ACC-01 §7.2 at every separation: does this person own a registered flow, app or connection? The register is what turns that from an unanswerable question into a thirty-second lookup.

> **Open question — who actually keeps the register**
> Often there is no Power Platform administrator role assigned. This document assumes one is named, and it should be named before §4 step 1 rather than after.
> RECOMMENDATION: a named Tier 3 administrator holds it, with a nominated deputy. Not one keeper — a register maintained by exactly one person is subject to precisely the failure mode described in §1, which would be an unusually poor joke to build into the control.
> ACTION: Head of IT to name the role and the deputy at approval. Owner: Head of IT.

5. Environments, and the default-environment problem

Every tenant has a default environment. It is created automatically, it cannot be deleted, every licensed user can build in it, and by default it is where everything gets built because it is the path of least resistance. Left alone, it becomes the organization's largest undocumented system.

- NO ISOLATION. Everything shares one data store and one policy. A permissive setting made for one purpose applies to everything anybody has ever built.
- NO LIFECYCLE. There is no development, test or production separation, so every change is made live, in the thing people are currently depending on.
- WEAK POLICY BY DEFAULT. A permissive default environment is the most common Power Platform governance failure there is, and it is entirely silent until it is not.
- INVISIBLE SPRAWL. Personal flows and abandoned apps accumulate with no owner review, which is exactly the population §4 step 2 has to triage. The position this document takes:

Environment	Purpose	Who can build	DLP policy
Default	Green personal productivity only (§3). Nothing organizational and nothing anybody else depends on.	All licensed users	Strictest. Business connectors only, HTTP blocked.
Departmental	Registered amber solutions, one per department or grouped where that is simpler.	Named makers per department	Standard classification (§6).
Production	Solutions IT has adopted under §9, and anything supporting an organization process.	IT makers only	Standard, with per-solution exceptions recorded.
Test	Paired with production. Where a change is proved before it reaches people.	IT makers only	As production.

- Creating environments has licensing and capacity implications, Dataverse capacity in particular. Confirm what the organization's licensing actually supports before designing four of them (M365-20). A three-environment shape that exists is better than a four-environment shape that is proposed.
- Moving an existing solution between environments is not always trivial — connections have to be re-established and references updated. Plan the departmental migration as a piece of work rather than as an afternoon.

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6. Data loss prevention: connector groupings

It is worth being precise about what a DLP policy on this platform actually does, because the name misleads people into expecting something else. It does not inspect data. It does not look for Social Security numbers or scan attachments. It controls which connectors may be used together in the same flow or app: Business connectors may be combined with each other, Non-business connectors may be combined with each other, and a solution may not bridge the two groups. Blocked connectors cannot be used at all.

Once that is understood, the classification stops being arbitrary. The point is to prevent a bridge between a system holding organization data and a service outside the organization — not to catch a sensitive string in transit.

Group	Connectors	Rationale
BUSINESS	SharePoint, OneDrive for Business, Office 365 Outlook, Office 365 Users, Microsoft Teams, Excel Online (Business), Microsoft Forms, Planner, Approvals, Dataverse, SQL Server, Azure / Entra ID, Power BI, and the organization's vetted line-of-business connectors.	Inside the tenant boundary, or covered by an organization agreement. These are the connectors organization data is allowed to move between.
NON-BUSINESS	General-purpose utilities with no organization data in them: RSS, weather, date and time helpers, public reference data, translation utilities where the content is not organizational.	Legitimate, and deliberately kept a short list. Their whole purpose is to be usable without touching anything in the Business group.
BLOCKED — consumer social	X / Twitter, Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Pinterest, Reddit, YouTube posting connectors.	A flow that posts a record to social media is almost never the intended design, and occasionally is the actual one. Departmental social media is published by people, not by automation reaching into a data source.
BLOCKED — personal cloud storage and mail	Dropbox, Google Drive, Google Sheets, Gmail, consumer OneDrive, iCloud, WeTransfer-style file services. Box likewise unless the organization holds an agreement for it, in which case it moves to Business with the decision recorded.	These move organization data out of the tenant to a service with no agreement behind it, and they do it on a schedule, silently, which is worse than a person doing it once.

Group	Connectors	Rationale
BLOCKED — unvetted HTTP	HTTP, HTTP with Microsoft Entra ID, HTTP Webhook, and custom connector creation outside the production environment.	These can send anything to anywhere. They are the standard way a governance model is bypassed — usually with no bad intent, by somebody solving a problem. Permitted in production only, by named makers, per solution, with a recorded Tier 4 approval.
BLOCKED — consumer AI and unvetted assistants	Third-party AI connectors, and any assistant the organization has no agreement with (M365-18 §3).	A flow that pipes organization content to a consumer model provider is a standing disclosure rather than a one-off paste.
BLOCKED — generic file transfer	FTP and SFTP to hosts not named in a reviewed integration.	Where an integration genuinely needs SFTP, it is an application under ACC-16 with a named endpoint, not a citizen flow with a hostname typed into it.

> **Two things a DLP policy will not do — and one it will**
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> It will not stop somebody emailing a spreadsheet to themselves, and it will not classify data. It is a coarse structural control.
>
> What it will do is make an entire category of accident impossible: the flow that quietly copies a departmental list to a personal Google Drive every night, built by somebody who had a genuine reason and no idea it was a problem. That is perhaps an hour of configuration and it is the highest-value hour available on this platform. The coarseness is not an argument against setting it.
>
> PUBLISH the classification, with the reasons. A blocked connector discovered at build time, with no explanation and no route to ask, is how a department concludes that IT is the obstacle and rebuilds the whole thing in Excel and email instead — which is worse in every respect and entirely invisible.
>
> EXCEPTIONS: named connector, named environment, named solution, named requester, Tier 4 approval, time-bound, recorded in the register. An exception route that exists and is used occasionally is a healthier sign than a policy nobody has ever asked to bend.

7. Connections, service accounts and ownership

> **The rule**
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> A registered flow does not run on an individual’s personal connection.
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> This is the single control that prevents §1. Everything else in this document is supporting work.

- Flows that run unattended, or that move data between systems, authenticate through a service account under ACC-08 — named, owned by a department, credentials held in the password vault, and emphatically not a person’s account whose password has been shared with a colleague (ACC-15 §3).

- Every registered solution has at least two owners, and where the platform allows it one of them is a group rather than a person. A single-owner flow is a single point of failure by construction, whoever that owner is.
- Where a solution genuinely must run under a named person's connection — some connectors offer nothing else — that is recorded in the register as a known risk against that person's name, and it becomes a trigger in the leaver checklist (ACC-01 §7.2, ACC-12 Appendix A). A known risk with a name on it is manageable; the same risk unrecorded is §1.
- Add the question to the separation checklist in plain words: does this person own any registered flow, app or connection? Without the register the honest answer is "nobody can say". With it, the answer takes thirty seconds.
- Connections need re-consenting after a password change, an MFA reset, or a conditional access change. A flow that stops working the day after a password reset is not broken — it is a connection awaiting consent. Tier 2 should recognise this pattern, because otherwise it arrives as five unrelated faults from five departments in the same week and gets diagnosed five times.
- Service accounts used by flows are subject to ACC-08 in full: no interactive use, no mail sending beyond what the solution requires, reviewed at the same cadence as every other non-human account, and never given administrative roles because it was easier than scoping them (ACC-07).

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8. What must never be built as a citizen solution

These are not "ask first" items. They are "this is an application, and it goes through §9".

- THE CORE BUSINESS SYSTEM. Nothing reads from or writes to the core business system of record as a citizen flow. It is typically vendor-supported, integrations to it are designed, tested and supported, and a flow built against it is a data integrity incident waiting for the next schema change or upgrade window.
- ANY SYSTEM OF RECORD. No writing to the core business system, the HR system, the finance system, the ticketing system or Entra ID. Reading may be permissible under §9 with a reviewed, scoped connection; writing is not, ever, from a citizen solution.
- PAYROLL DATA, in any form, including moving it between two places that are both allowed to hold it.
- REGULATED CLIENT RECORDS, beyond the boundary of the office that already holds them. Moving a record from the office that owns it to a departmental site is a disclosure decision, not a file copy.
- IDENTITY AND ACCESS ACTIONS. Nothing that creates, modifies, disables or deletes accounts, changes group membership, alters permissions, or assigns licences. That is administrative action by automation, and it belongs to ACC-01, ACC-07 and M365-20.
- BROADCAST MAIL. A message to a population is a mass communication and needs approval under M365-06 regardless of what sends it. A flow is not an exemption from an approval; if anything it is the case the approval exists for, because it can send to everybody at three in the morning without a human in the loop.
- DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE. Anything that assigns a rating, determines an award or eligibility, triggers a conduct process, or produces a decision about an individual. Automation that produces an outcome about a person needs to be an accountable system with an owner, not a flow.

- SECRETS IN THE OPEN. Credentials, API keys or connection strings held in flow variables, in a SharePoint list, or in an environment variable that anybody with maker access can read. This happens more often than people expect and it is usually done by somebody being resourceful.

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9. When a departmental solution has become an application

The transition is what nobody currently notices. Solutions accrete function until something breaks, and the conversation that should have happened at month four happens instead in an incident at month thirty. Naming the triggers gives both sides a moment to have it on purpose.

Any one of these means the solution is now an application:

- More than one department depends on it.
- It runs unattended, and something visible breaks if it stops for a day.
- It touches a system of record, or crosses a boundary between two systems.
- It handles data in the sensitive classes of M365-15.
- It has an interface used by people outside the department that built it.
- It has been running for more than a year and nobody can now explain how it works without opening it.
- Its ownership has changed twice. Each handover loses context, and the second one usually loses all of it.

9.1 What happens then

1. Either the department raises it, or IT raises it from the quarterly register reconciliation (§10). Raising it is not a criticism of the person who built it — in most cases it is a compliment about how useful the thing turned out to be, and it is worth saying so.
2. It goes through ACC-16 application onboarding: what it does, what it touches, who owns it, how it authenticates, what happens when it fails, and who is called when it does.
3. IT decides one of three outcomes, and says which: ADOPT — IT takes ownership, moves it to the production environment, and supports it under GOV-04 change control. SUPPORT IN PLACE — it stays with the department, IT has documented it and monitors it, and the department knows what it is responsible for. RETIRE AND REPLACE — it is doing something an existing supported system already does, and the right answer is to stop maintaining a second one.
4. “Adopt” is a real commitment and it is made deliberately, against the capacity to honour it. An IT department that adopts every departmental flow and then cannot maintain them has made the situation worse, not better, and has taken the department’s ownership away in exchange for nothing. It is honest and better to say: we are not adopting this, here is what you must do to keep running it safely, and here is what we will help with.
5. Once adopted, it is under GOV-04 from that day. Changes are changes, they go in a window, and they have a rollback. That is the trade the department gets in exchange for handing it over, and it is worth being explicit that the flexibility they had is part of what they are giving up.

10. Annual attestation and quarterly reconciliation

- ANNUALLY, alongside everything else under ACC-17, each registered solution's owner attests to five things: it is still needed; it still does what the register says it does; the named owner and deputy are correct; the connection is healthy and not personal (§7); and nothing it touches has changed.
- No response after two reminders escalates to the department head. Still no response means the flow is DISABLED — not deleted — with thirty days' notice, a named contact, and a route to turn it straight back on. Disabling something people quietly depend on is a real action with real consequences, and the notice and the contact are what make it fair rather than punitive.
- QUARTERLY, Tier 3 reconciles the register against a fresh admin-centre export and reports orphans: owner has left, connection failing, no successful run in 90 days, or a run failure rate above the threshold Tier 4 sets. Orphans are the population §1 is about.
- ANNUALLY to Tier 4: number of registered solutions, orphans found and dispositioned, solutions adopted or retired under §9, DLP exceptions in force and whether each is still needed.
- A solution that has not run in twelve months is a candidate for retirement. Asking the department is cheaper than keeping it, and the answer is usually "oh — no, we stopped doing that".

11. Support — what IT will and will not do

IT will	IT will not
Maintain the environments and the DLP policies, and publish the connector classification with its reasons (§6).	Debug a citizen-built flow line by line. Tier 2 will help with connections, permissions and authentication, which is where the great majority of faults actually are.
Answer "can I use this connector?" at Tier 2, in the conversation, with a reason rather than a refusal.	Write the flow for you outside an agreed piece of work. Advice is free; building is a project.
Hold the register, and tell a department in advance when a migration or a change is going to break their solution. This is the benefit departments should be sold on.	Support anything running in the default environment beyond green personal productivity (§3, §5).
Review a design before you build it. This is the cheapest support IT can offer on this platform and it should be offered warmly and often.	Grant an HTTP or blocked-connector exception because a deadline is close. The exception route in §6 exists and it takes a Tier 4 approval, which takes longer than planning ahead would have.
Help move a personal-connection flow onto a service account, and treat that as a good day's work rather than an imposition (§7).	Take ownership of an undocumented solution at the moment it fails. Adoption is a decision made in advance under §9, not a rescue accepted under pressure.
Adopt solutions that have outgrown their department, where there is capacity to maintain them, and say so plainly when there is not (§9).	Treat a department that built something useful as having done something wrong. They solved a problem IT did not get to.

12. Service levels

Activity	Commitment (per GOV-06)
“Can I build this? Which category is it?”	Answered at Tier 2 from §3, in the conversation.
Registration of a new solution (Appendix A)	Acknowledged within 2 coverage days; recorded within 5.
Design review before build	Offered within 5 coverage days. Worth waiting for and worth saying so.
Connector exception request (§6)	Tier 4 decision within 5 coverage days, with the reason given either way.
Service account for a registered flow (ACC-08)	P3 — 5 coverage days.
Orphaned flow found to be moving organization data	P2 — assessed within 1 coverage day; disabled where the risk warrants it, with the department told the same day.
A flow found to be doing anything in §8	Disabled the same coverage day, then discussed. The order matters and the department is told why.
Quarterly reconciliation, annual attestation	On schedule (§10).

13. Records

Record	Held in	Retention
The register: solution, purpose, owner, deputy, environment, connectors, connection type	IT register, published by department	Life of the solution + 3 years
Registration forms (Appendix A)	Ticket	3 years
DLP connector classification and its version history	IT governance record	Permanent
Connector exceptions: solution, connector, approver, expiry	IT governance record	Life of the exception + 3 years
Annual attestations	IT register (ACC-17)	3 years
Quarterly reconciliation reports and orphan dispositions	IT governance record	3 years
§9 adoption decisions, including decisions not to adopt	Application register (ACC-16)	Permanent

14. Related documents

ID	Title	Relationship
ACC-08	Service, Application & Non-Human Account Standard	§7 — what a flow authenticates as. The companion document.

ID	Title	Relationship
ACC-16	Application Onboarding, SSO & SAML Claims	§9 — where a solution goes when it has outgrown its department.
GOV-04	IT Change Management & Maintenance Windows	What governs an adopted solution from adoption onward.
ACC-01	Account Lifecycle	§7.2 leaver checklist — the moment a personal connection is caught.
ACC-12	Separation, Retiree & Affiliate Disposition	Appendix A of that document asks the ownership question.
ACC-17	Periodic Access Review & Entitlement Recertification	The §10 attestation runs with it.
ACC-07	Privileged & Administrative Account Standard	Why a flow's service account is not given admin roles for convenience.
ACC-15	Acceptable Use & Credential-Sharing Standard	A shared personal credential is not a service account (§7).
M365-15	Data Classification & Handling	§8 and §9 — what sensitive means.
M365-17	Microsoft Forms & Bookings Standard	What people build a flow around when Forms will not do it alone.
M365-18	Generative AI & Copilot Use in Microsoft 365	§6 — AI connectors, and what a flow may call.
M365-06	Mass Communication & Broadcast Email Approval	§8 — a flow is not an exemption from the approval.
M365-13	Legacy File Share Retirement & Migration	Flows referencing legacy share paths break at cutover.
M365-20	License Assignment, Reclamation & Cost Attribution	Environment, Dataverse and premium connector licensing (§5).
GOV-06	Service Commitments, Priority & Escalation	Supplies §12.

Appendix A — Registration form

Submitted to the service desk address, or completed with Tier 2 in a five-minute conversation, which is usually quicker. Green solutions (§3) do not need one.

Field	Entry
Solution name	Something a colleague would recognise in a list
What it does, in one sentence	
What breaks if it stops	The most useful field on this form

Field	Entry
Department	
Owner and DEPUTY	Two named people. One is not enough (§7).
Type	Flow / Power App / both
Environment	Default / Departmental / Production (§5)
Systems and data it touches	Where it reads from, where it writes to
Connectors used	Including anything in the blocked list — say so here rather than finding out at build time
Runs unattended?	YES / NO. If yes, §7 requires a service account.
Connection type	Service account (name it) / personal connection (name the person and the reason)
Any data in the sensitive classes of M365-15?	YES / NO / not sure — “not sure” is a fine answer and gets a conversation
Does it do anything in §8?	If yes, this is an ACC-16 request rather than a registration
— IT USE — Category assigned	Green / Amber / Red
— IT USE — Registered by, date, review date	

Appendix B — For departmental builders: building something that outlives you

Source text for the knowledge base, format per GOV-05. Written for the people this document is about rather than the people it is addressed to.

If you have built something in Power Automate or Power Apps that your department now relies on: thank you. Genuinely. You solved a problem that was not going to reach the top of anybody else’s list, and the organization is better off for it. This page is about making sure it survives you — not because you are going anywhere, but because that is exactly when these things break.

The one thing that matters most

Your flow almost certainly runs on your connection — your account, your sign-in, your permissions. That means that on the day your account is switched off, whether because you take a new role, retire, or move to another department, the flow stops. It does not warn anyone. It does not send an error to your colleagues. It just quietly stops, and the first anyone knows is when somebody notices, weeks later, that something has not been happening. Ask us to move it onto a service account instead. It is a small job, we are pleased to be asked, and it is the difference between a tool and a time bomb.

Tell us it exists

Not so we can take it away — we almost certainly do not want it, and we do not have the capacity to run everybody's. The point of the register is that when we migrate a system, retire an old shared drive, or change how sign-in works, we can tell you in advance that your flow is about to break, instead of you finding out afterwards. Right now we cannot do that, because we do not know what exists. Five minutes with the form in Appendix A, or a five-minute conversation with Tier 2, and you are on the list.

Give it a second owner

Somebody else in your department should be able to open it, and should know roughly what it does. One person who understands a thing is one holiday away from nobody understanding it. Two sentences written down — what it does, and what breaks if it stops — is all the documentation we are asking for, and it is more than most solutions have.

Things to bring to us rather than build

Anything touching the core business system. Anything that writes into a system where the organization keeps its official records. Anything involving payroll, or client records leaving the office that holds them. Anything that creates accounts or changes people's permissions. Anything that emails a whole population. None of that is a judgement about your ability — these are things that need to be supported when they break at an awkward moment, and supported by more than one person.

If a connector is blocked

You will occasionally find that a connector you wanted is not available. That is deliberate, and there is a list with the reasons on it. It is usually about data leaving the organization rather than about the tool itself. There is a route to ask for an exception, it takes a senior approval and a few days, and it is much better than the alternative of rebuilding the whole thing by hand in email — please come and ask instead of working around it.

Ask before you build, not after

A fifteen-minute conversation before you start is the cheapest thing we offer, and it usually makes the thing you build simpler rather than more complicated. Sometimes we will know that a system already does what you are about to build. Sometimes we will know that the connector you were planning to use is about to change. And sometimes we will just say: that sounds fine, go ahead, put it on the register when it works.

Part of the Known Good SOP Catalog by Kevin Zelman, written for small IT shops, contractors and consultants, career-changers and help desk technicians. Adapt the names, tiers and times to your own shop: the times here are cushion, not a promise.